A DEVELOPER'S DISCOVERY

I Installed DaVinci Resolve on Linux. Here's Every Wall I Hit.

Ubuntu 24.04 + Wayland + NVIDIA.
With Claude as my copilot.

Ubuntu 24.04 | Wayland | NVIDIA | Claude | DaVinci Resolve

THE SETUP

Linux for Engineering Was Working.
Now: Creative Work.

✅ **Low RAM Baseline**
1GB idle vs 5GB on Windows. More headroom for creative apps.

✅ **Native Docker**
No VM layer. Direct container access for development.

✅ **iGPU Assignment**
DRI_PRIME control. Dedicate dGPU to compute tasks.

❓ **Video Editing?**
Can the engineering stack handle a full creative workflow?

A few days ago I moved to Linux for engineering. The benefits were clear. Now the real test.

THE ADVERSARY

Wayland + Ubuntu 24.04

One Root Cause. Many Symptoms.

Dependency conflicts
Bundled vs system libraries. Resolve ships its own, Ubuntu has different versions.

Library mismatches
Renamed with t64 suffixes. Package names changed under Resolve's feet.

GPU errors
Misleading error messages. Pointed at memory when the real issue was elsewhere.

Missing packages
Not in default repos. Manual downloads or alternate sources required.

WAYLAND

ROOT CAUSES

UBUNTU 24.04

What should be "install and go" turned into a debugging session. Most issues traced back to the same root causes.

CLAUDE STEPS IN

Every Fix. One Mistake.

Claude solved each issue. Then got the big one wrong.

📖 **Read the error**
Parse logs & messages

→

🔍 **Search known issues**
Match against patterns

→

🔧 **Write the fix**
Apply & verify

→

✅ **Repeat**
Next issue

Each fix revealed the next issue. Wayland kept being the common thread. Then came the big one.

DaVinci Resolve

⚠️ **GPU Memory is Full**

Your GPU does not have sufficient memory for this operation. Playback has been disabled.

Actual VRAM usage — 4.8 GB free of 6 GB

THE CONVERSATION

C — CLAUDE
Looks like an OOM issue. Let's build proxies.

Y — YOU
Something doesn't add up.

THE REVEAL

Wayland Again.

Not a memory problem. A display server problem.

✕

Wayland

Display server broke GPU communication. Black playback, misleading errors.

✓

X11

Force X11 session. Full GPU access restored, everything works.

```
# Force X11 instead of Wayland
$ 3 environment variables + /opt/resolve/bin/resolve
```

Full 4K Playback

No proxies needed. No workarounds. Just the right display server.

Turns out it wasn't a memory problem. It was a Wayland compatibility issue.

WHAT'S NEXT

Diving Trip. Resolve MCP.

Pieces Coming Together.

DJI Action 4
Underwater action cam

Insta360 X5
360° underwater footage

footage - - → AI - - → timeline

I love editing, but the repetitive parts eat time I'd rather spend diving.
Found a DaVinci Resolve MCP. Still brainstorming.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What I Learned Setting Up Resolve on Linux

🔍 **Error messages lie.**

The GPU error pointed at memory. The real cause was the display server. Always read the logs.

🤝 **AI collaboration > AI answers.**

Claude got it wrong first. I steered us back. Neither would have solved it alone.

⚙️ **The engineering stack becomes the creative stack.**

Same Linux setup. Same hardware. Now running a full video editing workflow.

Anyone else using AI to streamline their video editing workflow?

Curious what people have landed on.